agency had developed a formidable network of informers in these countries and the steady flow of intelligence to R&AW headquarters was closely guarded.'

In the case of Rabinder Singh, there were apprehensions in various quarters during his visit to the CIA headquarters at Langley. This trip took place just before his posting at The Hague in mid-1999 and there were murmurs that his loyalty was up for sale. But the fervent pleas of several senior officers to mount surveillance against suspicious intelligence operatives fell on deaf ears. The USA was embarrassed by India's nuclear test in May 1998 and the CIA was blamed for not warning the US administration that the Atal Bihari Vajpayee government was about to change the security and strategic dynamics of the region.

For some US lawmakers it was the worst intelligence failure ever. And within the US intelligence community, even louder voices asked: what if we had a mole inside the system?

The Senate Intelligence Committee believed that the CIA had been surprised by India's nuclear test. The director of the CIA, George Tenet, asked retired Admiral David Jeremiah to chair a team of external experts to examine this failure on the part of the CIA and also examine the quality and quantity of intelligence reporting and analysis on the Indian nuclear tests. Jeremiah admitted that US spies failed to see India's nuclear test coming: whatever resources and assets the CIA had inside the Indian establishment had failed to analyse the true intentions of the BJP-led NDA government. In fact, Jeremiah believed that the Indian assets had fooled them. He said: 'There is a good deal of reporting, there is a good deal of activity inside the community on the nuclear issue but it was working against the